Prahlin Portfolio Work Log - November 1, 2026

Compiled summary for Sunday, November 1, 2026 - focus: continuing the Prahl.dev Portfolio after the October 22 UI / UX carousel and case-card record; explicitly verifying the United States Eastern date across the daylight-saving transition; running the customary project reader; extracting and studying the complete pre-existing PDF worklog archive; expanding all five UI / UX philosophy stacks into distinct A, B, and C presentations; correcting the rotating-star layer so its tip no longer obscured the active number tile; rebuilding My Workflow as five interactive, image-backed stages with 45 licensed images and exclusive card / column focus; adding focused A / B / C image rotation; refining workflow connectors, backgrounds, spacing, and responsive behavior; replacing the landing hero's single green role line with a controlled prismatic gradient; coordinating the eyebrow, project controls, chips, proof statistics, and arrow CTA with that palette; validating TypeScript and local route health; refreshing the Portfolio project snapshot; and generating the November 1 Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahlin Portfolio worklog format: compact opening summary, source-material review, baseline and goals, feature-grouped implementation details, committed-source sequence, validation, files and artifacts, follow-up notes, and output-artifact close. The record preserves the archive's dense technical voice, explicit repository evidence, and distinction between completed source work, local verification, and deployment activity.

Coverage begins after portfolio_worklog_october22.pdf and documentation commit ba5f861. Three source commits completed November 1: fab6c46, ef6e05f, and 181c032. At documentation time, HEAD, main, origin/main, and origin/HEAD all resolve to 181c0322016e969fde5e2053722deccc2f7d7e0f. No Hostinger synchronization, GitHub Actions dispatch, public deployment, external message, or additional source commit was performed during this worklog pass. The repository-local documentation outputs are the refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt and this PDF.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Date verification: checked an external UTC-05:00 clock, which reported Sunday, November 1, 2026 at 11:27 PM, and compared UTC-04:00, which had already crossed into Monday, November 2. TZ=America/New_York independently reported Sunday, November 1 at 11:27 PM EST (UTC-0500). Because Eastern daylight time ended on November 1, this record correctly uses November 1 and EST rather than the UTC-04:00 calendar date.
- Project reader: ran ./read_project.sh from /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio and regenerated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt with current source, assets, repository state, deployment notes, PDF inventory, and standing workflow instructions.
- Worklog archive: enumerated and extracted all 58 pre-existing root-level Portfolio PDFs with pdftotext, from portfolio_worklog_july11.pdf through portfolio_worklog_october22.pdf. Before this artifact, the series contained 323 pages and approximately 167,469 extracted words.
- Archive comparison: compared title and filename cadence, same-day Part suffixes, opening-summary density, recurring section order, feature-grouped bullet voice, Git and deployment disclosures, validation language, files-touched treatment, follow-up continuity, dated footers, page numbering, and output-artifact closure across the complete series.
- Nearest baselines: read October 22 in full and compared the October 18, October 16, October 15 Part 2, October 13, September 29 Part 2, representative August and July entries, and the July 11 first record. October 22 remained the direct UI / UX source baseline; September 29 Part 2 and October 13 supplied the closest My Workflow and five-tone visual-system history.
- PDF conventions: confirmed US Letter portrait at 612 x 792 points, PDF 1.4, black Helvetica-family copy on white, compact margins, bold section headings, a dated first-page title, repeated dated footers, right-aligned page numbers, and Codex metadata.
- Repository evidence: reviewed commit subjects, bodies, dates, statistics, and aggregate differences from ba5f861 through 181c032; inspected the current UI / UX decision data, workflow image selector and viewport-focus components, hero markup and styles, workflow license manifest, current branch tracking, and reader-refreshed snapshot.

Baseline Status Before November 1

- The October 22 baseline already contained five UI / UX philosophy decisions, three-position navigation, the rotating five-point star, active cutout masks, case-tone surfaces, and a vertically corrected number tile, but each stack still needed complete variant-specific messaging and a clearer A / B / C presentation language.
- My Workflow still read primarily as a text-led timeline. Its five stages did not yet provide three horizontally distributed image-backed points per stage, per-point A / B / C media, exclusive viewport focus, or case-study-like surface illumination.
- The landing hero still emphasized React Native / Kotlin with the older green treatment. Its bright green project controls, mint-heavy chips, uniform green proof values, and strong outlined arrow competed with the newer five-tone case-study and workflow systems.
- The work remained local-first. The October archive documented no new deployment requirement for this pass, and the user continued to request iterative browser review, reversible experiments, cache clears, and commits only after approving the visual result.

Goals for November 1

- Give every UI / UX philosophy stack three intentional content variants while preserving the established carousel geometry, star motion, screenshots, accessibility, and five-tone identity.
- Transform My Workflow into a visually demonstrable process: five stages, three evenly distributed points per stage, three unique images per point, one unambiguous active card and active point, and focused automatic cycling without simultaneous illumination.
- Make workflow surfaces inherit the case-study cards' opacity, sheen, color, hover motion, and center-of-viewport behavior without altering the colored star-gradient header strips.
- Bridge the hero to the green, blue, purple, orange, and yellow page systems with a controlled headline treatment and supporting accent changes while protecting the device montage, social buttons, layout, and unrelated hero elements.

Work Completed - UI / UX Philosophy Variants

- Expanded the decision model so each stack could provide an independent B or C headline, optional media, device description, device variant, project label, project link, screenshot source, and accessible alternative text while retaining its A presentation as the default.
- Reworked stack 01 around three distinct visual ideas. A retained Bold / Daring / WOW Before The First Tap; B became Sleek / Polished / NEVER Last-Year's Look with the Cinerific tablet; C became Focused / Precise / ALWAYS Directing The Eye with the Alla Vostra startup screen. The prior B and C placements, images, and supporting details were intentionally swapped during iteration.

- Completed stack 02 variants with Visible / 'Get'-able / BUILT For Action and Reactive / Telling / TRULY Mindful. Preserved the uppercase emphasis and added the requested underline behavior to the emphasized B and C phrases.
- Completed stack 03 with Adaptive / Flexible / READY For Every Screen and Fluid / Effortless / ALWAYS Flowing Like Water; stack 04 with Unified / Cohesive / SIMPLY Digestible and Familiar / Safe / NEVER Confusing; and stack 05 with Modular / Scalable / READILY Re-combinable and Dynamic / Moving / MADE For Change.
- Replaced the numeric 1 / 2 / 3 variant controls with A / B / C across all five stacks. Inactive controls use whitish letters and borders; the active letter follows the stack accent while its border remains whitish, preserving clear state without introducing gray.
- Updated accessible control labels and active-copy selection so assistive text follows the chosen A, B, or C content rather than exposing stale numeric wording.
- Lowered the rotating star's layer relative to the active number tile. This fixed the recurring case where a colored star tip visually obscured the number surface while the triangle controls, which lived outside that overlapping layer relationship, were never eclipsed in the same way.
- Preserved the accepted carousel navigation, five-color decision mapping, triangle behavior, star geometry, and active-state structure while making the number-tile fix localized and reversible.

Work Completed - My Workflow Structure and Content

- Removed the evidence sentences and all bottom description copy from workflow stages 01 through 05, leaving the section focused on process labels, images, interaction, and visual proof rather than long explanatory tails.
- Rebuilt each stage around three horizontally distributed point stacks, with the text header aligned from the image-frame placement rather than distributed independently. This corrected repeated left-versus-right gap inconsistencies and kept each header, frame, and selector operating as one visual unit.
- Added 15 responsive 16:9 image frames: three under each of the five stages. Restored the accepted larger image dimensions at 230 x 129 while keeping the A / B / C controls compact.
- Added 45 unique workflow JPEGs: three A / B / C images for each of the 15 points. The image set covers Discuss, Brainstorm, BG Research, Wireframing, Scaffold, Mockups, Build, Testing, Deployment, Review, Measure, Learn, Handoff, Launch, and Upkeep.
- Selected software-development, design, research, testing, deployment, analytics, learning, and release imagery from royalty-free, copyright-permitted, or public-domain sources. Recorded source URLs, creators, licenses, and per-file mappings in public/images/aboutdev/workflow/LICENSES.md.
- Renamed Industry Research to BG Research and increased the 15 white point headers by 50 percent. Removed the preceding green A:, B:, and C: prefixes so the headers read cleanly above the image frames.
- Placed UI / UX-style A / B / C framed controls below every workflow image. Each control now changes the image in its own frame and retains whitish borders with the active letter following the current stage tone.
- Extended the vertical connector through section 05, hid connector segments where they crossed the number and header boxes, and repaired missing top-left border corners caused by the previous line masking treatment.
- Expanded the RELEASE title/header area to consume the available width and removed the awkward empty right-side gap while retaining the five-stage header-strip composition.

Work Completed - Workflow Focus, Surfaces, and Carousels

- Added WorkflowViewportFocus as the exclusive card-focus controller. Hover selects a stage on pointer devices; clicking a stage scrolls it smoothly to the vertical center; viewport position selects the nearest stage when its center passes through the workflow range.
- Guaranteed that no two workflow stages are highlighted simultaneously. A click temporarily owns focus during auto-scroll, then releases back to hover or viewport-center logic; leaving a hovered stage does not disable center-based selection.
- Kept one stage highlighted while the viewport center remains between the top of stage 01 and bottom of stage 05, while allowing no stage to remain artificially highlighted when the viewer is above or below the workflow region.
- Segmented each active stage into three independently illuminable thirds. Point A is the default; hovering B or C transfers illumination to that sibling and releases the previous point. The corresponding one-third background follows the same exclusive focus state.
- Inherited the case-study cards' dimmed idle opacity, active sheen, colored surface, hover illumination, and slight jiggle / reposition behavior for workflow cards. The colored star-gradient strips at the vertical top of each stage remain exempt from the inherited background treatment.
- Added WorkflowImageSelector as a per-point three-image carousel. Only the currently focused point in the currently focused stage auto-advances A to B to C and back to A; all other point carousels pause.
- Set the final dwell time to 1.5 seconds after testing one-second and two-second intervals. Synchronized the active letter and image opacity so the visual frame changes with the selector instead of animating the controls alone.
- Stopped point-selector clicks and pointer-down events from bubbling into the stage click handler, preserving manual A / B / C selection without causing unintended stage auto-scroll.
- Honored reduced-motion preferences when centering a clicked stage and used requestAnimationFrame, MutationObserver, ResizeObserver, scroll listeners, and cleanup handlers to keep focus and autoplay responsive without leaving stale listeners or intervals.
- Preserved responsive distribution, image aspect ratios, stage color mapping, and connector continuity across the workflow section while consolidating the behavior into two reusable client components.

Work Completed - Hero Headline and Palette

- Created six exploratory headline raster mockups covering smooth rainbow, dark-seam, prismatic, deep-blend, muted-blend, and satin-blend treatments before selecting a code-native gradient for the live hero.
- Kept Full-Stack and Developer in their original whitish treatment. Applied the gradient only to the two-line React Native / Kotlin span so the role remains readable and the accent does not overwhelm the hero hierarchy.
- Iterated the gradient direction, rotation, stop spacing, and optional black overlays. Removed the overlay after testing 25, 33, 40, and 50 percent oscillations, then retained a slower three-color green-to-blue-to-purple blend that avoids striped transitions.
- Adjusted the final purple stop so the slash and Kotlin row both receive visible purple; allowed purple to take more space from blue; preserved a distinct green region without letting green dominate; and used an OKLab linear gradient for smoother transitions.

- Changed the eyebrow from the earlier green treatment to the exact yellow workflow family: #E8AA01 text, #CB7D00 border, and a faint #FFD102 surface tint. This connects the text to the warm Alla Vostra device frame and the page's five-tone system without duplicating the headline gradient.
- Protected the existing hero device montage, portrait, bridge quote, social button colors, layout, proof panel structure, and supporting typography during the gradient experiments.

Work Completed - Hero Controls, Chips, and Proof

- Changed only the hero project controls from saturated green fills to a neutral dark translucent surface with whitish borders and restrained green hover / focus feedback. The active project category moved to a softer neutral label color.
- Rebuilt the downward CTA arrow as a local inline SVG so its black outline could be reduced without changing the shared carousel-arrow asset used elsewhere. Slimmed the white stroke and retained the familiar arrow shape.
- Restored all four rounded corners on the isolated arrow button, softened its green illumination and glow, and restored the accepted 2 px upward hover movement after testing a motionless state.
- Reduced the green cast in the nine technology chips with neutral translucent backgrounds, softer whitish borders, and less-minty text while leaving case-study tags and unrelated chips unchanged.
- Mapped the four hero proof values to the established palette: 3yrs green, 1.0k blue, 0.2k purple, and 8 gold. Kept their descriptive labels neutral and increased the consistent value-to-label gap.
- Cleared the scoped .next/dev cache and restarted the local Next.js server when stale output prevented the accepted source changes from appearing. Cache clearing remained limited to generated development data.

Committed Source Sequence

- fab6c46 - Refined the UI/UX philosophy carousel variants and presentation. Added the final per-stack B / C headlines and supporting media, swapped stack 01 B / C content, changed variant controls to A / B / C, updated accessibility, and lowered the star layer to protect the number tile.
- ef6e05f - Rebuilt the My Workflow section with interactive image carousels. Added 45 licensed images and attribution, independent per-point selectors, focused 1.5-second auto-rotation, exclusive viewport / hover / click focus, case-study-like surfaces and motion, and the completed workflow layout cleanup.
- 181c032 - Refined the hero's prismatic visual system and interactive controls. Added the live green / blue / purple role gradient, yellow workflow eyebrow palette, neutral project controls and chips, four-color proof values, refined inline arrow CTA, and six exploratory gradient mockups.
- At documentation time, HEAD, main, origin/main, and origin/HEAD all resolve to 181c0322016e969fde5e2053722deccc2f7d7e0f. The three source commits are synchronized; no source commit or push was performed while generating this PDF.

Validation Summary

- Verified the Eastern date externally at UTC-05:00 and locally with America/New_York. The UTC-04:00 comparison had crossed into November 2, confirming that the November 1 EST date required explicit DST-aware handling.
- Ran the repository's standard project reader and reviewed the refreshed snapshot, source tree, asset inventory, deployment notes, Git state, and all 58 earlier worklogs.
- npm run check completed successfully during the final hero pass and again during this documentation pass; TypeScript reported no errors.
- The local Next.js route at http://localhost:3000 returned HTTP 200 after the scoped development-cache restart. Earlier implementation checkpoints also recorded successful production-build validation for the workflow work.
- git diff --check passed for the tracked source and public asset scope. A whole-tree check reports pre-existing line-number tab whitespace inside the generated snapshot's embedded source dump; that reader output was not reformatted manually.
- Reviewed branch refs and all three November 1 commit bodies and statistics. No deployment, Hostinger synchronization, GitHub Actions dispatch, public publish, or external communication occurred during this record.

Files Touched and Artifacts

- app/UiUxDecisionShowcase.tsx - per-variant headline and media support, active-copy selection, A / B / C accessibility, and localized carousel presentation behavior.
- app/WorkflowImageSelector.tsx - new manual and focused-autoplay A / B / C image selector with synchronized image state and event isolation.
- app/WorkflowViewportFocus.tsx - new exclusive viewport, hover, point, click, smooth-scroll, and cleanup controller for five workflow stages and 15 point stacks.
- app/ProjectCarouselButton.tsx - hero CTA arrow converted from the shared image asset to a locally tunable inline SVG with lighter outline geometry.
- app/page.tsx - final UI / UX variant copy and media, rebuilt five-stage workflow markup and image data, BG Research rename, prismatic headline span, and retained hero / device composition.
- app/globals.css - UI / UX star layering and A / B / C styling; workflow sizing, distribution, backgrounds, connectors, opacity, focus, motion, and responsive rules; hero gradient, eyebrow, project controls, chips, proof colors, and arrow states.
- public/images/aboutdev/workflow/ - 45 new 16:9 workflow JPEGs plus LICENSES.md with source and license attribution.
- public/mockups/hero-headline-rainbow-01-smooth.png through hero-headline-rainbow-06-satin-blend.png - six retained headline exploration artifacts.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - reader-generated project snapshot refreshed at 11:27 PM EST before this PDF was composed.

Follow-Up Notes

- Keep the rotating star behind the active number surface. The triangle controls do not share the same overlap path, so future fixes should continue to target the star / number stacking context rather than moving the triangles.
- Preserve exclusive workflow focus: one stage and one point may be active within the workflow region, with A as the point fallback. Avoid independent hover rules that can illuminate siblings simultaneously.
- Keep autoplay limited to the focused point and retain the 1.5-second interval unless a future usability test justifies a different dwell time. Manual selector interaction should continue to avoid triggering card auto-scroll.

- Maintain public/images/aboutdev/workflow/LICENSES.md with any future image additions or replacements. The 45-image set depends on retaining its source and license record.
- Protect Full-Stack and Developer as neutral framing text if the role gradient changes. The current three-color accent intentionally bridges the hero to later sections without reproducing the full five-color spectrum in one headline.
- Keep the yellow eyebrow, prismatic role line, neutral chips, multicolor proof values, and device montage in hierarchy. Adding gradients to additional hero surfaces would risk competing with the screenshots.

Output Artifact

- Generated /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_november1.pdf using the established lowercase-month, unpadded-day naming convention. No Part suffix was needed because no earlier November 1 root-level Portfolio worklog existed.
- The title and filename use Sunday, November 1, 2026 after explicit EST / UTC-05:00 verification at 11:27 PM and comparison against UTC-04:00 across the daylight-saving boundary.
- The artifact uses US Letter portrait pages, black Helvetica-family text on white, compact technical bullets, repeated dated footers, page numbers, and Codex document metadata.
- The synchronized source baseline is 181c0322016e969fde5e2053722deccc2f7d7e0f. No application source changes were made during worklog generation.
- The repository-local documentation outputs from this pass are the refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt and this November 1 PDF.